

grids as visual aids in the works of Indian artist Abdul Aziz Raiba (1922-2016). The show, called *Master Artist A.A. Raiba: A Unilateral Eclectic*, collects a series of preparatory sketches Raiba made for his more famous, large-scale paintings, as well as a series of landscape sketches made by the artist during a Kashmir stint in the late 1950s.

In these sketches, you can see how Raiba used grids to plot out his larger compositions, à la Rivera, making sure that he got the proportions correct. Fragments of a human figure with a rooster evoke the artist's famous 1964 painting, 'Man With Cock', for example. The grid helped him organise his thoughts, not to mention the precise form, colour and mood that the work required. These grid-sketches are also revelatory because we clearly see how Raiba, a man trained in the Indian miniature painting style, came to incorporate several different influences from around the world. In the essay accompanying the exhibition, art historian Shivaji K. Panikkar writes about Raiba's "unique fusion of Indo-Islamic traditions, European academic naturalism, the Bengal school and European modernity".

> IN THE SKETCHES, YOU CAN SEE HOW RAIBA USED GRIDS TO PLOT OUT HIS LARGER COMPOSITIONS

This was a versatile artist who was more than familiar with the dominant methods and applications of his day, always seeking to reinvent himself. And this exhibition gives us a peek behind the curtain, so to speak, allowing us to witness the evolution of a true original. ■

***—Aditya Mani Jha***

Master Artist A.A. Raiba: A Unilateral Eclectic *is on view until Jun. 21 at Thapar Gallery, Delhi*



▲ **BIKANER HOUSE** | ***New Delhi | On view till May 28***

## Silent Stories

Gallery Silver Scapes introduces Sri Lankan artist Shanaka Kulathunga to Indian audiences. Drawing on evocative paintings shaped by memory, rural life and everyday encounters, the exhibition explores intimacy, identity and human connection through richly layered figurative works that quietly bridge the cultural landscapes of India and Sri Lanka.

▶ **JHAVERI CONTEMPORARY** | ***Mumbai | On view till May 30***

## CEYLON

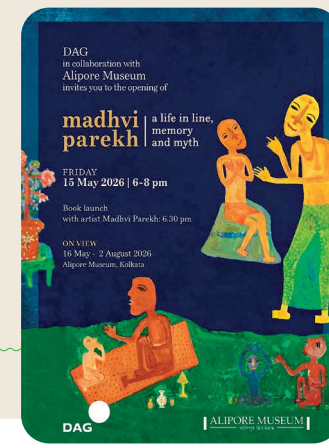


**CEYLON revisits the photographic practice of Lionel Wendt, whose modernist images transformed colonial-era representations of Sri Lanka. Bringing together portraits, labour studies and landscapes, the exhibition foregrounds Wendt's lyrical exploration of the body, desire and atmosphere through gelatin silver prints that blur realism and dream, intimacy and performance.**

▶ **THE ALIPORE MUSEUM** | ***Kolkata | On view till Aug. 2***

## Madhvi Parekh: A Life in Line, Memory and Myth

At this DAG exhibition, nearly six decades of Madhvi Parekh's work unfold through paintings, drawings and sketchbooks that blur folklore, domestic memory, and dreamlike imagination.




*—compiled by* ***Nikhil Sardana***